

MAPAL OS

Paid Media Forward Strategy

Audit, strategy, and the path to leading pipeline. Google, LinkedIn, Microsoft and Meta across UK, Iberia, France and LATAM. Built on the 90-day spend audit, the 17-month Meta export, and the Dynamics 365 attribution review.

THE SIX FINDINGS THAT MATTER MOST

Ranked by how much each changes the picture.

We judge paid on incremental lift, proven by holdout, not platform-reported conversions.

#	Finding	What it says
1	Paid is undercounted, not underperforming	Dynamics (where sales work deals) shows paid at 120 opps and ~€1.05M pipeline over 12 months, 19 won. HubSpot surfaces only ~19. The gap is a reporting break, not performance.
2	Bidding was set for volume, not value	Top-spend campaigns in ES, UK and FR Microsoft ran on Maximize Clicks: most clicks for the money, no regard for conversions. High clicks, near-zero conversions.
3	Brand defence was switched off for five months	UK brand defence paused on Google and Microsoft since early December. It had the lowest cost per conversion in the account. Competitors bid on Mapal terms unopposed.
4	Budget went to products a market cannot sell	French Microsoft ran Workforce; the Spanish account carried LATAM Workforce. Both against the agreed product-market map. Off-map spend is waste by definition.
5	Narrow audiences failed; broad correct ones worked	Same FR offer, same form: a narrow 3,400 list gave 0 leads, a broad 22K audience gave 3 leads at a clean cost. Narrow hand-built lists starve the platform of signal.
6	The conversion signal was broken	Lead MQL and SQL events were not firing into Google, LinkedIn or Microsoft. Tags are healthy; the break is at the event layer. No campaign can bid toward a conversion it never sees.

Why paid looks small, and why that is now fixable.

Paid looks like a small pipeline source in HubSpot. It breaks in three specific ways, and all three push paid's number down, not up. The CRM model is sound; the breaks are upstream.

How it breaks	What happens
Historic source hides under legacy IDs	Old deals store the source under an option ID from an earlier version of the field. The label still reads correctly, but reports match the current ID, so they come back blank. Recoverable with a re-map.
The sync writes source, not our UTMs	Deals created by the Dynamics sync carry a source written by Dynamics. Without UTMs in place, new web-tracked paid leads can arrive with no campaign attached, so credit lands nowhere.
Last touch steals the credit	A paid click that converts later on a demo form gets logged to the last touch, often "Request a Demo". Paid did the work; another line takes the report. The biggest source bucket hides paid this way.

What this means. The real figure is not "in progress" any more, Dynamics already holds it. With UTMs set correctly, go-forward paid measures properly in HubSpot for the first time, and the platforms finally get a conversion signal to bid on. The historic clean-up sits with RevOps.

The source data exists, and it is clean in the system of record.

Paid in Dynamics, 12 months	Opps	Pipeline
United Kingdom	47	-
France	46	-
Spain	27	-
Total paid (Search + Social)	120	~€1.05M
Of which won	19	-
Attached to a named paid campaign	101	19 with no campaign
Shown as paid in HubSpot today	~19	the reporting floor

Hold these caveats. €1.05M is pipeline, not revenue; the closed part is the 19 won. Denominator is marketing opps, not all company pipeline. And 120 is itself a floor: paid-driven demo fills sit in "Request a Demo" via last touch. The re-map that recovers the historic ~10,920 deals is provisional, to verify on sample deals first. The HubSpot attribution design is sound; the breaks are upstream.

On closed business, paid is a top-two source.

Marketing source, 12 months	Opps	Pipeline	Won	Win rate
Request a Demo (last touch)	394	€6.04M	62	15.7%
Marketing Event	138	€1.73M	7	5.1%
Marketing Email	120	€1.37M	2	1.7%
Paid (search + social)	120	€1.05M	19	15.8%
Website	81	€0.66M	13	16.0%

What this means. By pipeline value paid is fourth, because value counts opportunities created, not deals won. On closed-won deals paid is second only to the last-touch demo bucket, and ahead of website, events and email, converting at 15.8% while email wins almost none of its larger pipeline. Request a Demo is a last-touch destination, not a channel, so paid's true standing is higher still. One open item: a separate filtered view ranks paid third by value, and its window needs reconciling with this full export.

Bidding bought clicks instead of conversions.

Should have run: flagship on conversion bidding into a working Lead MQL event, secondary products capped, Display fenced or off.
Instead: 9 of 10 top campaigns on Maximize Clicks.

Campaign	Bid strategy	Spend 90d	Conv.	Read
Workforce-ES Search	Maximize Clicks	€7,305	1	Mobile €6,593 / 0 conv; desktop €79. Pause mobile.
Easyls-ES	Maximize Clicks	€5,131	0	No conversions, wrong bid strategy.
Compliance-ES	Maximize Clicks	€2,587	0	Secondary product on uncapped clicks.
Workforce-LATAM	Maximize Clicks	€2,000	0	Off-map, nested in the ES account.
Flow-ES	Maximize Clicks	€1,523	2	Only top-10 campaign with any conversions.
4x Display	Maximize Clicks	~€900 ea	0-1	No placement exclusions on 666-782K impressions each.

Held up: 4 product-segmented negative keyword lists in active use (better than UK).

Year on year: cost +49%, conversions -65%, cost per conversion +321%.

The right product, split across twelve campaigns.

Should have run: one consolidated Easyls search campaign + one Performance Max, both feeding a single clean conversion, geos as ad groups. Instead: 12 overlapping variants splitting budget and signal.

Campaign / issue	Spend 90d	Conv.	Read
Easyls Perf Max v3	€3,167	4	PMax converts when the signal reaches it. The model works.
Easyls Scale keywords v3	€2,619	0	One of 7 of the top 10 campaigns at zero conversions.
Easyls Perf Max (paused)	€2,120	4	Also converted; paused anyway.
"logiciel restauration collective"	€2,443	-	Same phrase running across 3 separate campaigns.
Keyword spread (52 KWs)	€9,160	-	44% of FR Google budget not aligned to the consolidated play.
Conversion layer	-	-	18 of 29 actions Removed but still flagged primary in goals.

Held up: 542-keyword Easyls negative list on 26 campaigns (genuinely good, stays). Product direction was correct.

Year on year: cost +74%.

The cheapest campaign in the account was switched off.

Should have run: brand defence always on, flagship on conversion bidding, generic terms restructured or stopped. Instead: brand defence paused since early December while expensive generic terms ran on Maximize Clicks.

Campaign	Bid strategy	Spend 90d	Conv.	Read
Brand defence (paused)	(was manual)	-	162 life	€13.64 lifetime cost per conversion. The cheapest in the account, switched off.
Flow-Hospitality Training	Maximize Clicks	€3,445	0	Expensive generic terms, no conversions.
Mapal-Hospitality software	Maximize Clicks	€2,154	0	Same pattern.
Mapal Demo Form (conv)	-	-	20 flag	Google flags the tag "needs attention"; the count is not trustworthy.

Held up: only brand defence, on past performance. Also zero negative keyword lists, ~69,000 placement exclusions attached to nothing.

Year on year: cost +75%, conversions -62%, cost per conversion +360%.

Narrow hand-picked audiences failed; broad correct ones worked.

The controlled test (FR, same offer, same form)	Spend	Leads	Read
Narrow 3,400 list (51% wrong vertical)	€441	0	Below LinkedIn's 50K delivery threshold. Starved of signal.
Broad 22K audience (correctly targeted)	€444	3	€148 CPL, 21 leads to life. Won by being larger and correctly targeted.

Market	What was running	What we do
EN	Narrow account-list ad set live at €20/day, chasing landing-page clicks across 5 countries.	Budget too small to exit learning. Stop it, replace with the broad lead-form campaign.
ES	Account-list set paused. Two lead forms (whitepaper + one other) each produced 5 leads.	Reuse those two proven forms on a broad Workforce audience.
FR	Narrow play killed. A ready 1.28M-member audience (90%+ match) sat unused.	Build the rebuild on that 1.28M audience.

Efficiency gap: narrow lists cost €184/click vs €8.28 broad. The creative was good (training-gap hook, 4-ad matrix) and carries forward. Targeting and tiny budget were the problem.

Built by import rather than strategy, and mostly switched off.

Account	What was running	Worst numbers	Read
EN (UK)	Entire account paused. ~€393/day idle. Target CPA set to €6 on hospitality software (real range €100-400+), so it never spent. Helsinki time zone, euros not pounds.	5 generic KWs: €1,569 / 0 conv	Rebuild deliberately, do not un-pause. Fix tCPA, time zone, currency.
FR	42 campaigns auto-imported from an external Google account. All CORE on Maximize Clicks. 4 Workforce campaigns (wrong product). Audience Network display running. Held up: the French Easilys brand campaign converts at ~€143, the one positive signal and the anchor for the FR rebuild. A 250-keyword Easilys negative list (the best in the account) was attached to zero campaigns.	Workforce €785/1 · Audience Network €900/1 (31% of FR spend)	Kill Workforce + Audience Network. Rebuild around Easilys + brand.

The real question: Microsoft is effectively a new channel (zero spend a year ago). Not "fix Microsoft" but "decide what Microsoft should be," including a Spain account that does not exist today.

Not unproven. Running 17 months, mostly at the wrong goal.

Meta ran 17 months and ~€14,958 with no one accountable for whether it worked, and its pixel died ~4 weeks ago unnoticed. Same root cause as the rest of paid.

What the data shows	Number	Read
Spend on Traffic / Awareness, not Leads	73% (~€10,857)	Buying clicks and reach, not customers. Same disease as Google Maximize Clicks. Biggest line: FR Easilys remarketing €4,482 (Traffic, 0 leads).
Audience Network leak (ES + FR)	€3,421	ES put 52% of all Spain spend (€2,389) on the lowest-quality placement. FR another €1,031. Same as the Microsoft Audience Network leak.
Lead form (Facebook) vs landing page (FR)	€26 vs €84	Same offer, form 3x cheaper. But scaling waits on tracing these leads to pipeline (same trace as Google). Cheaper to capture, value not yet confirmed.
Pixel status	Dead ~27d	Main pixel stopped firing; 2 Lead + 2 Lead_SQL events in 28d. Four zombie pixels. Lead forms survive only by bypassing the pixel.
Live right now	FR only	€2,899 in last 90d, France only. ES and UK fully paused. Dormant, not scaling.

What we do: exclude Audience Network, fix the pixel, standardise on native lead forms, tracing the leads to pipeline before scaling. The growth team's video runs inside the lead-form structure, where it converts, not as standalone awareness.

WHAT THE AUCTIONS ACTUALLY SHOW

We were partly bidding against a competitor set that is not there.

The set assumed in HQ planning does not match the live auctions. That gap is itself a finding: spend aimed at the assumed fight is partly wasted. Targeting now follows the observed competition.

Market	Who actually shows up	What it means
France	Lightspeed dominant (top of ~52% of auctions), Skello primary rival, Sage present.	A point-of-sale and Easilys fight. Confirms keeping Workforce out and consolidating on Easilys.
Iberia	HR and payroll tools (tramitapp, factorial). No Lightspeed.	Workforce stays the local flagship, but messaging competes on the HR / payroll axis, not POS.
UK	LMS and training tools (Absorb and similar) alongside the POS names.	Flow's training-to-execution angle (the creative that held up) is on the right axis.
Cross-market	The workforce names HQ assumes (Fourth, Deputy and similar) barely appear anywhere.	Planning against an imagined competitor wastes spend. We plan against the observed one.

Brand defence matters most where rivals actively bid on Mapal terms, confirmed in France on Bing where competitors appear in 1 to 56% of Mapal-brand auctions.

Six strategy errors repeat across every account.

#	Pattern	Where it shows
1	Volume-not-value bidding	Maximize Clicks on Google's biggest campaigns in ES, UK and FR Microsoft. Same on Meta, where 73% of spend chased clicks and reach, not leads.
2	Narrow hand-picked LinkedIn audiences	Account lists below the delivery threshold, starved of the signal the algorithm needs to improve.
3	Brand defence switched off	The cheapest, highest-intent campaign type, paused on two engines while competitors bid on Mapal terms.
4	Spend on products a market cannot sell	FR Microsoft Workforce, LATAM Workforce. The product-market map was not the operating filter.
5	Operating against a broken signal	Conversion events removed, inactive, or never firing across Google, LinkedIn, Microsoft. The Meta pixel has been dead ~4 weeks too.
6	Budget leaking to the worst placements	Microsoft Audience Network, and the same on Meta: €3,421 over 17 months on the lowest-quality network, on a B2B audience.

WASTE

What was spent with no return, and what we can get back.

Each line is 90-day spend on a campaign that returned zero or near-zero conversions and was structurally wrong. The annual column assumes the pattern continues.

Item	Platform / Market	90d, no return	If it continues
Workforce-ES Search, mobile	Google / ES	€6,593	€26,755
FR keyword spread (52 KWs, 12 variants)	Google / FR	€9,160	€37,160
Hospitality Jobs audience leak (5 of 6 wrong)	Google / UK + FR	€5,356	€21,737
Spain Display, 4 new launches	Google / ES	€3,156	€12,806
FR Microsoft Audience Network	Microsoft / FR	€901	€3,656
FR Microsoft Workforce (4 campaigns)	Microsoft / FR	€785	€3,185
Meta Audience Network (17-mo figure)	Meta / ES + FR	€3,421	17-mo total
Observed total (Google + Microsoft, 90d)		~€26,000	~€105,000

HOW WE REBUILD

Four on Google, three on LinkedIn, two on Microsoft, three on Meta.

Every campaign funded above the platform's learning threshold, tied to one flagship product or audience, measured against a working conversion.

Google · 4 / market	LinkedIn · 3 / market	Microsoft · 2 / market	Meta · 3 / active market
Brand defence: always on, manual / impression share	Lead form, broad ICP: built toward / above 50K	Brand defence: captures 5-10% Google misses	Native lead form: cheaper format; scale once leads traced
Flagship search: conversion bidding, 30+ conv/mo	Sponsored content: mid-funnel, builds retarget pool	Generic high-intent: MS-specific keyword variants	Conversion remarketing: replaces reach-buying
Generic high-intent: cross-product demand	Retargeting: engaged audiences	(Open a Spain account, Q3, none today)	Video in lead-form: the growth team's creative, not standalone
Demand Gen + remarketing: one clean audience			

Before Meta scales: exclude Audience Network, fix the pixel, delete the 4 zombie pixels. ~33 campaigns total across four platforms: one person can run weekly hygiene across that; the current sprawl cannot be run well by anyone.

WHAT WE KEEP, AND EXACTLY WHY

Nothing is switched back on as it was.

Anything kept is rebuilt to the naming convention, given a working conversion, and put on the correct bid strategy. Two things earn their place.

Brand defence (UK Google + Microsoft)	The broad lead-form model (from France)
Why it earns its place: before it was paused it ran at €13.64 cost per conversion across 162 conversions, the cheapest converting campaign in the account. While off, competitors take branded demand that is ours.	Why it earns its place: it is the only LinkedIn campaign that produced leads at a sensible cost on a correctly-targeted audience (€148 CPL, 21 leads to date).
How we keep it: rebuild (not un-pause) to the naming convention, on a brand-appropriate bid strategy (never Maximize Clicks), with a clean conversion attached, small daily budget, monitored weekly.	How we keep it: replicate the structure (broad ICP, native lead form, single offer) to the UK and Spain. We keep the model, not the specific French ad set.

Everything else is killed, consolidated, or rebuilt from scratch.

THE PLAN

This is more than a few campaigns. The real scale:

Kill	Consolidate	Pause / attach now	Rebuild (from mid-June)
Last live narrow LinkedIn ad set (EN)	12 FR Easilys variants to 1 campaign	Pause Workforce-ES mobile (- €2,200/mo)	Brand defence, UK Google + Microsoft
4 FR Microsoft Workforce campaigns	3 FR Easilys lead-form plays to 1	Remove 5 wrong audience attachments	Lead-form playbook: UK Flow + ES Workforce
FR Microsoft Audience Network	"logiciel restauration collective" 3 to 1	Attach 250-KW Easilys neg list (FR MS)	UK A/B video + Blog 2 ads, broad ICP
Auto-apply recommendations, all 3 Google		Attach orphaned remarketing + exclusions	Neg KW libraries (UK) + ES exclusions

Plus cleanup: 18 removed FR conversions still primary, the defunct ES "Compra" conversion, legacy 2020-21 LinkedIn audiences, orphaned shared-library items. Bid migration to conversion bidding follows the tracking fix.

BUDGET + DEPENDENCIES

Concentrated spend, funded by cutting waste and scaled as it proves out.

Market	Paid search	Paid social	Total Jun-Dec	Full-year (approx)
France	32,000	11,000	43,000	~96,500
UK	27,000	8,000	35,000	~83,300
Iberia	20,000	9,500	29,500	~67,200
LATAM (MX)	1,500	1,000	2,500	~7,600
All	80,500	29,500	110,000	~254,600

Iberia social now sits ahead of UK social for the period. Top-ups beyond the firm 110,000 euro floor are staged and deployed only on confirmation.

Depends on	What it unlocks
Conversion-signal fix (us + website lead)	Unlocks conversion-based bidding. A site dataLayer break (migration), ours + the website lead's. Gates measurement, not lead gen.
Paid UTM model + Dynamics sizing (us)	New paid leads roll up to a campaign. Dynamics already gives 120 opps / ~€1.05M now; UTMs give the same in HubSpot.
Cross-system attribution + legacy re-map (RevOps)	UTMs to deal records, campaign write-back, stop Dynamics overwriting source, plus the legacy re-map. Verify first.
Consolidation sign-off (leadership)	Cutting campaign count reads as "doing less" without the rationale.

Paid and nurture run as one engine, not two teams.

Most B2B buyers are not ready on first touch. Judged only on first-touch leads, paid throws away most of the demand it pays to create. The fix is a closed loop.

Step	The loop	What happens
1	Paid captures intent	Search for ready-now. Lead forms and content on LinkedIn and Meta for earlier intent.
2	Everyone enters a HubSpot audience	Segmented by product, market, and how far along they are.
3	Nurture works the not-ready	Sequenced, relevant content until behaviour signals readiness.
4	Paid remarketing reinforces it	Stays present on Google, LinkedIn, Meta so the brand never goes quiet between emails.
5	Sales-ready convert, attributed to paid	Warm leads close higher, and the closed deal traces back to the paid source that started it.

The biggest lever is not more spend. It is the nurture-and-remarketing layer that did not exist before, the cheapest of all because it works demand we already paid to create.

HubSpot audiences are where paid and nurture meet.

The pieces exist in fragments (a preserved 1.28M French matched audience, the Engagement line, remarketing in the product map). The work is to assemble them into one system that turns paid from a lead source into a pipeline source.

Build now (parallel to tracking)	Activate once tracking is healthy
Behavioural segments in HubSpot. From form fills, content, pricing/demo page views, email engagement. Keyed to product (Flow, Workforce, Easyls) and market.	Sync segments out to the platforms. Google Customer Match, LinkedIn matched audiences, Meta custom audiences. Paid stays in front of who nurture is working.
Nurture sequences per segment. Move the not-ready-yet toward sales-ready with relevant, sequenced content.	Lookalikes from best-converting segments. How the broad-but-targeted model that won on LinkedIn scales without hand-picking lists. Then feed closed-won back so bidding learns from real revenue.

Audiences are only as good as the data feeding them, so the sync waits on the tracking fix. The segment and sequence design does not, and starts now.

THE ROUTING GAP, NOW LARGELY CLOSED

Non-demo leads are now created, qualified and routed. Two small gaps remain.

A central routing workflow is live: it creates, qualifies and routes the non-demo leads (whitepaper, guide, event, product-page) to an owner, splits current customers to Customer Success, dedups against open leads, and blocks the clear non-fits. For paid that closes the worst dead-end. Two gaps remain, and both are small.

Step	The piece	What it does
1	Paid-source label on entry	Ours to set: a clean paid-source label on entry, so paid leads are visible and reportable in the routed flow.
2	Nurture the non-demo leads	Ours, no dependency: sequenced nurture by segment that works the leads between touches. Builds now.
3	Score and graduate	RevOps Phase 2: automatic scoring grades and graduates on fit and intent, swaps in cleanly when it lands.
4	Route, and notify on non-demo	Routing to an owner is live. Residual: only demo requests alert an SDR, so add a queue view or daily digest. RevOps + SDR side.
5	Monitor and escalate softly	A light check that paid leads are worked, with soft escalation. SDRs are at 63% of target, so priority not a punitive timer.

No paid lead should dead-end. Default routes to the SDR queue; for named or higher-value accounts it can route to a LinkedIn-connect task instead, tracked the same way. The nurture works now; only the remarketing sync waits on the conversion-tracking fix.

TWO JOBS, ONE BUDGET

Evergreen always-on, plus paid support for growth.

Paid has two jobs: always-on campaigns that capture demand year-round, and supporting the growth team's events, webinars, content and video. Search is intent capture and stays evergreen. Social is where the two compete, so growth gets a named, ring-fenced share.

Platform	Evergreen	Growth support	Why
Google	100%	0%	Intent capture. Never sacrificed to promote an activity. Search angles for growth fold into evergreen.
Microsoft	100%	0%	Same as Google, smaller volume, same logic.
LinkedIn	70%	30%	Primary B2B demand-gen and ABM surface. Always-on ABM runs in evergreen; the ring-fenced share is the growth team's for events and content, used only for an ABM burst that amplifies one.
Meta	75%	25%	Reach and video for event awareness + retargeting. Smaller growth slice than LinkedIn.

The growth share is a ceiling, not a floor. No active campaign that month, it reverts to evergreen so nothing sits idle. Heavy event month, it borrows above the ceiling with sign-off. Re-set each quarter. Today most event promotion is organic, which caps reach on activity we already paid to produce.

Account-based done the way it actually works.

The audit killed the old ABM for good reason: narrow lists below threshold, InMail spam, €441 for 0 leads at €184/click. The account-based intent was never the problem, the mechanics were. We keep the intent and replace the mechanics, in three tiers.

Tier	Who	Paid approach	Measured on
Tier 1	Named strategic accounts (10-30 logos sales most wants)	High-touch company-targeted LinkedIn + retargeting. Higher CPC accepted because deal size justifies it. One-to-one: marketing warms, sales closes.	Account engagement + meetings, not CPL
Tier 2	Best-fit segments, the workhorse (hotel groups, QSR/FSR, caterers), audiences 50K+	The proven broad-but-targeted model: native lead forms + sponsored content. One-to-few with sequenced nurture.	CPL, MQL, SQL by segment, then pipeline
Tier 3	Broad ICP + lookalikes from Tier 1/2 converters and closed-won	Widest correctly-targeted audience. Lowest cost, feeds the funnel and the retargeting pool, graduates contacts up into Tier 2.	Volume, cost efficiency, pool contribution

ABM sits in evergreen, not the growth slice, which frees that share for the growth team. Tier 2 and 3 start now; Tier 1 scoring and pipeline attribution follow the tracking fix. The preserved 1.28M French audience becomes the FR Tier 2/3 base. To leadership: yes to ABM, built the way that works.

Grow the customers we already own.

Acquisition wins the logo; expansion grows it. The cheapest pipeline we have is the customers we already serve, and it is the motion the acquisition loop points to whenever it holds current customers out.

Step	The motion	What happens
1	Cross-sell the next module	Flow to Compliance, Workforce to Compliance, Easilys to Flow. Each account, the adjacent gap, in its own market.
2	Up-sell what they already have	More sites across the estate, more seats, a higher tier, the renewal uplift.
3	Gate on health (the one hard rule)	Only green-health accounts get an expansion ask. An at-risk account is a save, never a sell.
4	Marketing warms, account owners close	Customer nurture and customer-match ads surface the moment; Customer Success and account management own the sale.
5	Judge on expansion, not clicks	Net revenue retention and expansion revenue, proven against a held-out set of matched accounts.

The cheapest pipeline we have. It runs on the customer database we already own, and switches on in Q3 once product-usage and account-health data are wired in.

Incremental lift, not platform-reported conversions.

Platforms over-count: a paid click that would have happened anyway, for free, is not new business. So we reactivate brand defence, but we treat its value as a hypothesis to test rather than an article of faith. The standard, on every channel: judge paid on incremental lift, proven by holdout.

The strongest case: brand defence	How we prove it: a geo holdout
Where the case is strongest. Where competitors bid on our terms, confirmed on French Bing. There a branded click we would otherwise lose to a rival is genuinely incremental, so defending it is worth real money. Where no rival bids, the click was likely ours for free anyway.	The test. Brand defence on where rivals bid our brand, off in a comparable market where they do not. Compare branded conversions over four to six weeks. If conversions hold steady with paid off, the spend was not incremental and the budget moves to where lift is real.
The wider principle. The principle generalises. Cheap last-click CPA can hide spend that buys conversions which would have arrived anyway. We plot year-on-year so seasonality does not get read as lift, and we reallocate to where the lift is real rather than spending because the budget exists.	Where it comes from. The discipline comes from large-scale holdout testing in the industry, most famously the Uber case, where a single set of experiments reallocated roughly 35 million dollars once it showed how much spend was buying conversions that would have come for free.

This sharpens the brand-defence case rather than weakening it: we turn it back on, and we hold it to the same incrementality bar as everything else. We would rather move budget to where the lift is real than spend because the budget exists.

Buyers get answers without clicking, and shortlist inside assistants.

What is happening AI answers resolve broad queries in place, so those clicks fall and the cost per click on the rest rises. Buyers shortlist inside assistants before they ever search.	What we do in search Tilt to high-intent, brand and comparison terms where a click is genuinely incremental, and defend comparison terms.
How we judge Incremental lift via holdout, not platform-reported conversions.	Who owns AI-answer visibility SEO, content and PR own it; paid amplifies. Flagged for the wider team, not absorbed into paid.

HOW PAID SUPPORTS THE GROWTH TEAM

A menu of proven plays, each judged on pipeline.

Request type	Proven play	Judged on
Webinar or event	Single-image Sponsored Content with a native Lead Gen Form to a broad ICP, synced to HubSpot, with reminder and post-event sequences.	Registrations to attendees to SQLs
Whitepaper, guide or report (gated)	Lead Gen Form ad to a broad ICP plus retargeting, into nurture. Native form, not a landing page (about 26 vs 84 euros per lead in our data).	Cost per lead and MQL rate
Named-account push (ABM)	Tier 1 only when sales provides 10 to 30 named logos: company-targeted Sponsored Content plus retargeting, high-touch.	Meetings booked, not cost per lead
Product or feature awareness	Video or single image to a broad ICP as a view-through layer that feeds retargeting, not a direct-response ask.	Assisted pipeline and influenced opps
Brand and competitor defence	Always-on, owned by paid (not a growth-team request), named here so it is understood as protected.	Incremental conversions, proven by holdout

Search stays evergreen. Every play needs a working conversion and a tracked form before launch.

Fund the rebuild from cut waste. Net position stays positive.

Line	Per year	What it is
Commit-publicly recovery	€35-55K	Realistic recovery (€67,410) with conservatism for execution risk + CPC inflation. The number to lead with.
Conservative floor	€22-30K	HIGH-confidence items only, deeper haircut. Use only if challenged for the floor.
Stretch	€70-100K	If tracking lands and the lead-form model scales to UK + ES. Q4, multiple dependencies. Upside only.
Already booked	€8,993	Forward run-rate prevented by stopping the failed LinkedIn account-based campaigns (killed 25 May).
Reallocation / net-new	€15-25K	UK brand defence + lead-form playbook + FR public-sector LP. Smaller than recovery, so net stays positive.

Read it as: we are not asking for more money. We cut the waste, fund fewer campaigns properly, and the recovery is larger than the reinvestment. Meta's go-forward spend redeploys what it already burned on the wrong objectives.

THE SHORT VERSION

The spend was spread thin, bid for clicks not customers, and measured on a broken signal.

We concentrate it, fix the measurement, defend the brand, scale the one model that worked, and wire paid to nurture so we stop wasting the demand we already pay for. The point that matters most: **paid is not weak, it is undercounted.** Dynamics already shows ~€1.05M in pipeline from paid in 12 months, while half-broken and half-paused. Fix the loop and paid earns its place among the top sources of pipeline and ARR at Mapal, next to website, SEO, and the nurture it now feeds.